

INTERNATIONAL news **NVIDIA surpasses Apple and Microsoft to become the most valuable company**

NVIDIA has surpassed Apple and Microsoft to become the world's second most valuable company, driven by a stock split and high demand for its AI processors. NVIDIA's stock reached record



Representational image

highs, surpassing a \$3 trillion market cap, fuelled by a 5.2% rise in its shares. Overall optimism about AI technology has boosted chip stocks, with NVIDIA playing a central role in this trend.

Apollo to acquire 49% stake in Intel's Fab 34 in Ireland

Intel and Apollo have agreed to a joint venture where Apollo will invest \$11 billion to acquire a 49% stake in Intel's Fab 34 in Ireland, allowing Intel to redeploy capital while maintaining operational control. The transaction is expected to close in Q2 2024. The investment aims to support Intel's semiconductor manufacturing operations, particularly for Intel 4 and Intel 3 process technologies. The joint venture will supply wafers to Intel and potentially other customers, with minimum volume commitments post-facility completion.

Google Tensor G5 to upgrade to TSMC 3nm tech from Samsung's 4nm process

Google's upcoming Tensor G5 chip will utilise TSMC's 3nm technology, and upgrade from Samsung's 4nm process (used in Tensor G4), potentially improving efficiency and performance to compete with Apple's latest processors. Samsung's struggles with 3nm yield and efficiency could lead to losing major customers like Google to TSMC. Other tech giants like NVIDIA and Qualcomm are also favouring TSMC's 3nm process over Samsung's offerings.

South Korea announces \$19 billion support package for chip sector

South Korea has announced a significant \$19 billion support package, allocated through the Korea Development Bank, to facilitate major investments by semiconductor companies. It has

created a fund of 1 trillion won to aid fabless companies and equipment manufacturers.



Representational image

China sets up third fund with \$47.5 billion to boost chip sector

China has established a third investment fund amounting to \$47.5 billion aimed at enhancing its semiconductor industry. The fund aims to support domestic semiconductor companies, research, and development efforts in cutting-edge technologies.

European labs to receive \$2.72 billion under European Chips Act

Leading European research labs, led by Belgium's imec, are set to receive €2.5 billion (\$2.72 billion) under the European Chips Act to establish a pilot line for advanced computer chip development. This initiative seeks to provide access to expensive chip manufacturing technology for European industry, academics, and startups. imec will host the pilot line for these advanced chips.

onsemi invests \$2 billion in Czech chip plant

onsemi, a US chipmaker, has planned a significant \$2 billion investment in a Czech semiconductor plant to enhance European production capabilities, focusing on silicon carbide chips for automotive and renewable energy sectors. Production of intelligent power semiconductors could commence by 2027. Upon approval, the Czech government is expected to offer incentives up to 27.5% of the investment.

TRI and NVIDIA partner to deploy AI-driven tech

TRI (Test Research Inc.) is partnering with NVIDIA to integrate AI-driven technologies into smart factories, enhancing automation and defect detection processes. NVIDIA's AI software stack will support visual inspection applications from edge to cloud and enhance automated optical inspection (AOI) and defect detection accuracy. The companies plan to integrate NVIDIA Triton Inference Server and TensorRT to further accelerate AI inferencing for smart factories.

ity is now producing double side and multi-layer PCBs for specialised electronic segments. The unit has created 110 direct jobs and 150 indirect employment opportunities. It includes upgraded single side PCB lines and a Class 100k clean room for quality control.

Essar to invest ₹300 billion in green hydrogen plant

Essar Group plans to invest ₹300 billion in a green hydrogen plant in Jamnagar, Gujarat, aiming to enhance its clean energy footprint and expand into decarbonisation

projects globally. Essar Future Energy aims to develop 1 gigawatt of hydrogen capacity and associated green molecules production annually in Jamnagar. The company will utilise 4.5GW of renewable energy from Essar Renewables to produce hydrogen via electrolysis.